Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1060

1. **A** *There was no sunlight there.*

2. **C** *This passage describes life deep in the ocean and the process of natural selection.*

3. **D** *Animals and plants change over time based on where they live.*

4. **B** *Scientists realized that life can exist in places without sunlight and oxygen.*

5. **B** *Life is extremely adaptable and can be found even in harsh environments.*

6. **A** *changed*

7. **C** *previously*

8. **Suggested answer:** *All students should be able to identify the lack of sunlight as one reason. They may also identify the presence of sulfur, thought to be poisonous, as another reason.*

9. **Suggested answer:** *Bacteria used the sulfur from the vents to make food. Animals like worms and shrimp ate this bacteria.*

10. **Suggested answer:** *Answers may vary. At minimum, students should recognize that the bacteria and animals around the vents showed scientists that life could exist in conditions previously thought to be prohibitive to life. A more complex answer might involve a discussion of adaptation. For example, students could infer that the bacteria, which make their food from sulfur, are an example of organisms that have adapted to their environment.*

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